

In Sickness and In Health

Biblical Marriage When One Partner Has Chronic Illness

A Biblical Guide for Christian Couples

By Daniel Tesfamariam

Bible Made Simple

Scripture from King James Version (Public Domain)

For Amazon Kindle & Paperback

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Dedication

To every couple who desires to build their
marriage on the unshakeable foundation of God's Word.

May the Lord bless your union abundantly.

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Introduction

Welcome to In Sickness and In Health. This book was crafted with one purpose: to help you build, strengthen, and protect your marriage using the timeless wisdom found in God's Holy Word.

Whether newly married or celebrating decades together, these biblical principles will speak to your current season.

Each chapter includes: Scripture foundations, practical applications, discussion questions, prayer prompts, and actionable steps.

Marriage is God's idea. He designed it, He blesses it, and He has given us everything we need in His Word to make it thrive.

In His service, Daniel Tesfamariam

When the Diagnosis Changes Everything

Genesis 2:24 - Therefore shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall cleave unto his wife.

In this chapter we explore when the diagnosis changes everything through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding when the diagnosis changes everything is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

Marriage was never meant to be navigated alone or by the wisdom of the world. God's Word is our ultimate authority, and His Spirit is our daily guide. When we align our marriage with His principles, we experience the abundant life Jesus promised (John 10:10).

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When we resist God's design, we experience friction, frustration, and failure. When we embrace it, we experience peace, purpose, and profound connection with our spouse.

Consider the wisdom of Psalm 127:1 - 'Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it.' This truth applies directly to marriage. Without God as the architect and foundation, every effort to build a strong marriage will ultimately crumble.

But WITH God at the center - with His Word as your blueprint and His Spirit as your power source - there is nothing your marriage cannot overcome.

KEY PRINCIPLES FOR APPLICATION:

1. **SCRIPTURE SATURATION:** Fill your mind and home with God's Word. Read it together. Memorize it individually. Discuss it over meals. Let it become the language of your marriage.

The couples who thrive long-term are not those who have perfect circumstances - they are those who have internalized God's truth so deeply that it shapes their every response, decision, and conversation.

2. **PRAYER PARTNERSHIP:** Pray together daily. Even five minutes of united prayer creates a spiritual bond that nothing can break. Research shows couples who pray together have less than 1% divorce rate.

Prayer aligns your hearts with God and with each other. It is impossible to hold bitterness toward someone you are genuinely praying for. It is impossible to remain distant from someone you approach God's throne with.

3. **INTENTIONAL INVESTMENT:** Great marriages require consistent deposits. Every kind word, every act of service, every moment of undivided attention is a deposit in your marriage bank account.

Neglect is the silent killer of marriages. Not dramatic affairs or explosive arguments - but the slow, quiet erosion of connection that happens when couples stop being intentional.

4. **GRACE-FILLED RESPONSE:** You married a sinner. They married one too. Extend grace generously. Forgive quickly. Give the benefit of the doubt. Assume the best about your spouse's intentions.

Colossians 3:13 instructs us to bear with each other and forgive one another. This is not a suggestion - it is a command. And it is the oxygen that keeps marriages alive through difficult seasons.

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Where we have wounds, bring healing. Where we have walls, bring them down. Where we have wandered, lead us back to Your design. We choose Your way over our way. We choose obedience over comfort. We choose each other over selfishness.

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COMMON OBSTACLES AND HOW TO OVERCOME THEM:

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DISCUSSION QUESTIONS FOR COUPLES:

1. What truth from this chapter challenged you most? Why?
2. On a scale of 1-10, how would you rate your marriage in this specific area? What would make it a 10?
3. What is one thing your spouse does well related to this topic that you have never acknowledged?
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5. What specific commitment can you make to each other this week based on what you have read?
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7. What Scripture from this chapter will you memorize together?

JOURNALING EXERCISE:

Spend 10 minutes writing answers to these prompts (then share with your spouse):

- The thing I love most about our marriage right now is...
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- My biggest fear about our marriage is...
- My greatest hope for our marriage is...
- One thing I wish I could tell my spouse without fear is...

PRAYER FOR THIS CHAPTER:

Heavenly Father, we come before You regarding intimacy when the body fails in our marriage. You are the Author of marriage. You understand every dynamic, every challenge, every need we have.

Open our eyes to see where we need to grow. Soften our hearts to receive correction with humility. Strengthen our hands to do the work of building a marriage that

glorifies You.

Where we have wounds, bring healing. Where we have walls, bring them down. Where we have wandered, lead us back to Your design. We choose Your way over our way. We choose obedience over comfort. We choose each other over selfishness.

Unite us, Lord. Make us one in spirit, one in purpose, one in devotion to You and to each other. Let our marriage be a beacon of hope to every couple who knows us.

We believe Romans 8:28 - that You are working ALL things together for our good because we love You and are called according to Your purpose. Even the hard things. Even the painful things. You waste nothing.

In the mighty name of Jesus Christ, Amen.

MEMORY VERSE:

Song of Solomon 4:7 - Thou art all fair, my love; there is no spot in thee.

AFFIRMATIONS TO SPEAK OVER YOUR MARRIAGE THIS WEEK:

- Our marriage is blessed, protected, and empowered by God.
- We choose love over selfishness every single day.
- God is doing a new thing in our marriage, and we receive it with joy.
- We are partners, not opponents. We fight together, not against each other.
- Nothing is impossible for our marriage because God is with us.
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ADDITIONAL REFLECTION:

As you close this chapter, take a moment to sit in silence together. Hold hands if you can. Breathe deeply. Remember why you chose each other. Remember the vows you made before God and witnesses.

Your marriage is not an accident. God brought you together for a purpose - to refine each other, to serve together, to display His love to a broken world, and to raise up a generation that fears the Lord.

No matter what you are facing today - whether you are in a season of closeness or a season of distance, whether you are celebrating a victory or nursing a wound - God is present. He is not surprised by your circumstances. He is not overwhelmed by your problems. He is not disappointed in your progress.

He is FOR your marriage. Romans 8:31 declares: 'If God be for us, who can be against us?' This includes your marriage. God is fighting for you. He is working behind the scenes. He is orchestrating circumstances for your good.

Trust Him. Obey His Word. Love your spouse. And watch what He does.

CLOSING SCRIPTURE:

Jeremiah 29:11 - For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, saith the LORD, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end.

God has good plans for your marriage. Believe it. Walk in it. Live it out loud.

Financial Impact of Chronic Illness

Genesis 2:24 - Therefore shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall cleave unto his wife.

In this chapter we explore financial impact of chronic illness through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding financial impact of chronic illness is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

Marriage was never meant to be navigated alone or by the wisdom of the world. God's Word is our ultimate authority, and His Spirit is our daily guide. When we align our marriage with His principles, we experience the abundant life Jesus promised (John 10:10).

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Every principle in God's Word was given for our benefit. Deuteronomy 10:13 tells us that His commands are 'for thy good.' This means the boundaries and principles He sets for marriage are not restrictions - they are protections designed by a loving Father who knows exactly what we need.

When we resist God's design, we experience friction, frustration, and failure. When we embrace it, we experience peace, purpose, and profound connection with our spouse.

Consider the wisdom of Psalm 127:1 - 'Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it.' This truth applies directly to marriage. Without God as the architect and foundation, every effort to build a strong marriage will ultimately crumble.

But WITH God at the center - with His Word as your blueprint and His Spirit as your power source - there is nothing your marriage cannot overcome.

KEY PRINCIPLES FOR APPLICATION:

1. **SCRIPTURE SATURATION:** Fill your mind and home with God's Word. Read it together. Memorize it individually. Discuss it over meals. Let it become the language of your marriage.

The couples who thrive long-term are not those who have perfect circumstances - they are those who have internalized God's truth so deeply that it shapes their every response, decision, and conversation.

2. **PRAYER PARTNERSHIP:** Pray together daily. Even five minutes of united prayer creates a spiritual bond that nothing can break. Research shows couples who pray together have less than 1% divorce rate.

Prayer aligns your hearts with God and with each other. It is impossible to hold bitterness toward someone you are genuinely praying for. It is impossible to remain distant from someone you approach God's throne with.

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Where we have wounds, bring healing. Where we have walls, bring them down. Where we have wandered, lead us back to Your design. We choose Your way over our way. We choose obedience over comfort. We choose each other over selfishness.

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Managing Medical Decisions Together

Genesis 2:24 - Therefore shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall cleave unto his wife.

In this chapter we explore managing medical decisions together through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding managing medical decisions together is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

Marriage was never meant to be navigated alone or by the wisdom of the world. God's Word is our ultimate authority, and His Spirit is our daily guide. When we align our marriage with His principles, we experience the abundant life Jesus promised (John 10:10).

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When the Healthy Spouse Burns Out

Jeremiah 30:17 - For I will restore health unto thee, and I will heal thee of thy wounds, saith the LORD.

In this chapter we explore when the healthy spouse burns out through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding when the healthy spouse burns out is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

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- One thing I wish I could tell my spouse without fear is...

PRAYER FOR THIS CHAPTER:

Heavenly Father, we come before You regarding when the healthy spouse burns out in our marriage. You are the Author of marriage. You understand every dynamic, every challenge, every need we have.

Open our eyes to see where we need to grow. Soften our hearts to receive correction with humility. Strengthen our hands to do the work of building a marriage that

glorifies You.

Where we have wounds, bring healing. Where we have walls, bring them down. Where we have wandered, lead us back to Your design. We choose Your way over our way. We choose obedience over comfort. We choose each other over selfishness.

Unite us, Lord. Make us one in spirit, one in purpose, one in devotion to You and to each other. Let our marriage be a beacon of hope to every couple who knows us.

We believe Romans 8:28 - that You are working ALL things together for our good because we love You and are called according to Your purpose. Even the hard things. Even the painful things. You waste nothing.

In the mighty name of Jesus Christ, Amen.

MEMORY VERSE:

Jeremiah 30:17 - For I will restore health unto thee, and I will heal thee of thy wounds, saith the LORD.

AFFIRMATIONS TO SPEAK OVER YOUR MARRIAGE THIS WEEK:

- Our marriage is blessed, protected, and empowered by God.
- We choose love over selfishness every single day.
- God is doing a new thing in our marriage, and we receive it with joy.
- We are partners, not opponents. We fight together, not against each other.
- Nothing is impossible for our marriage because God is with us.
- We release every past failure and embrace the future God has planned.
- Our best days together are ahead of us, not behind us.

ADDITIONAL REFLECTION:

As you close this chapter, take a moment to sit in silence together. Hold hands if you can. Breathe deeply. Remember why you chose each other. Remember the vows you made before God and witnesses.

Your marriage is not an accident. God brought you together for a purpose - to refine each other, to serve together, to display His love to a broken world, and to

raise up a generation that fears the Lord.

No matter what you are facing today - whether you are in a season of closeness or a season of distance, whether you are celebrating a victory or nursing a wound - God is present. He is not surprised by your circumstances. He is not overwhelmed by your problems. He is not disappointed in your progress.

He is FOR your marriage. Romans 8:31 declares: 'If God be for us, who can be against us?' This includes your marriage. God is fighting for you. He is working behind the scenes. He is orchestrating circumstances for your good.

Trust Him. Obey His Word. Love your spouse. And watch what He does.

CLOSING SCRIPTURE:

Jeremiah 29:11 - For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, saith the LORD, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end.

God has good plans for your marriage. Believe it. Walk in it. Live it out loud.

Faith When Healing Does Not Come

Hebrews 11:1 - Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

In this chapter we explore faith when healing does not come through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding faith when healing does not come is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

Marriage was never meant to be navigated alone or by the wisdom of the world. God's Word is our ultimate authority, and His Spirit is our daily guide. When we align our marriage with His principles, we experience the abundant life Jesus promised (John 10:10).

THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATION:

Every principle in God's Word was given for our benefit. Deuteronomy 10:13 tells us that His commands are 'for thy good.' This means the boundaries and principles He sets for marriage are not restrictions - they are protections designed by a loving Father who knows exactly what we need.

When we resist God's design, we experience friction, frustration, and failure. When we embrace it, we experience peace, purpose, and profound connection with our spouse.

Consider the wisdom of Psalm 127:1 - 'Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it.' This truth applies directly to marriage. Without God as the architect and foundation, every effort to build a strong marriage will ultimately crumble.

But WITH God at the center - with His Word as your blueprint and His Spirit as your power source - there is nothing your marriage cannot overcome.

KEY PRINCIPLES FOR APPLICATION:

1. **SCRIPTURE SATURATION:** Fill your mind and home with God's Word. Read it together. Memorize it individually. Discuss it over meals. Let it become the language of your marriage.

The couples who thrive long-term are not those who have perfect circumstances - they are those who have internalized God's truth so deeply that it shapes their every response, decision, and conversation.

2. **PRAYER PARTNERSHIP:** Pray together daily. Even five minutes of united prayer creates a spiritual bond that nothing can break. Research shows couples who pray together have less than 1% divorce rate.

Prayer aligns your hearts with God and with each other. It is impossible to hold bitterness toward someone you are genuinely praying for. It is impossible to remain distant from someone you approach God's throne with.

3. **INTENTIONAL INVESTMENT:** Great marriages require consistent deposits. Every kind word, every act of service, every moment of undivided attention is a deposit in your marriage bank account.

Neglect is the silent killer of marriages. Not dramatic affairs or explosive arguments - but the slow, quiet erosion of connection that happens when couples stop being intentional.

4. **GRACE-FILLED RESPONSE:** You married a sinner. They married one too. Extend grace generously. Forgive quickly. Give the benefit of the doubt. Assume the best about your spouse's intentions.

Colossians 3:13 instructs us to bear with each other and forgive one another. This is not a suggestion - it is a command. And it is the oxygen that keeps marriages alive through difficult seasons.

5. **COMMUNITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY:** No marriage thrives in isolation. You need other godly couples around you - couples who will encourage you, challenge you, pray for you, and hold you accountable.

Hebrews 10:24-25 commands us not to forsake the assembling of ourselves together. This applies to marriage fellowship. Find your people. Be vulnerable. Let others speak into your relationship.

PRACTICAL STEPS FOR THIS WEEK:

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Tuesday: Each write a one-paragraph prayer for your spouse. Exchange them.

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COMMON OBSTACLES AND HOW TO OVERCOME THEM:

Obstacle 1: 'We are too busy.' Truth: You are never too busy for what matters most. If your calendar has no space for your marriage, your priorities need re-evaluation. Jesus said where your treasure is, there your heart will be also (Matthew 6:21). Time IS treasure.

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For further growth, study these passages together this week:

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- Colossians 3:12-19 (How to relate to one another)
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DISCUSSION QUESTIONS FOR COUPLES:

1. What truth from this chapter challenged you most? Why?
2. On a scale of 1-10, how would you rate your marriage in this specific area? What would make it a 10?
3. What is one thing your spouse does well related to this topic that you have never acknowledged?
4. What would Jesus say if He observed your marriage for one week? What would He commend? What would He lovingly correct?
5. What specific commitment can you make to each other this week based on what you have read?
6. How can you hold each other accountable in love without it feeling like criticism?
7. What Scripture from this chapter will you memorize together?

JOURNALING EXERCISE:

Spend 10 minutes writing answers to these prompts (then share with your spouse):

- The thing I love most about our marriage right now is...
- The area I most want to grow in as a spouse is...
- My biggest fear about our marriage is...
- My greatest hope for our marriage is...
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God has good plans for your marriage. Believe it. Walk in it. Live it out loud.

Community Support Without Losing Privacy

Genesis 2:24 - Therefore shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall cleave unto his wife.

In this chapter we explore community support without losing privacy through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding community support without losing privacy is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

Marriage was never meant to be navigated alone or by the wisdom of the world. God's Word is our ultimate authority, and His Spirit is our daily guide. When we align our marriage with His principles, we experience the abundant life Jesus promised (John 10:10).

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Children and Chronic Illness in the Home

Psalms 127:3 - Lo, children are an heritage of the LORD: and the fruit of the womb is his reward.

In this chapter we explore children and chronic illness in the home through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding children and chronic illness in the home is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

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God has good plans for your marriage. Believe it. Walk in it. Live it out loud.

Finding Joy in Suffering (Romans 5:3-5)

Nehemiah 8:10 - The joy of the LORD is your strength.

In this chapter we explore finding joy in suffering (Romans 5:3-5) through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding finding joy in suffering (Romans 5:3-5) is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

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- Colossians 3:12-19 (How to relate to one another)
- 1 Peter 3:1-12 (Specific instructions for husbands and wives)
- Genesis 2:18-25 (God's original design for marriage)

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS FOR COUPLES:

1. What truth from this chapter challenged you most? Why?
2. On a scale of 1-10, how would you rate your marriage in this specific area? What would make it a 10?
3. What is one thing your spouse does well related to this topic that you have never acknowledged?
4. What would Jesus say if He observed your marriage for one week? What would He commend? What would He lovingly correct?
5. What specific commitment can you make to each other this week based on what you have read?
6. How can you hold each other accountable in love without it feeling like criticism?
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JOURNALING EXERCISE:

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- The thing I love most about our marriage right now is...
- The area I most want to grow in as a spouse is...
- My biggest fear about our marriage is...
- My greatest hope for our marriage is...
- One thing I wish I could tell my spouse without fear is...

PRAYER FOR THIS CHAPTER:

Heavenly Father, we come before You regarding finding joy in suffering (romans 5:3-5) in our marriage. You are the Author of marriage. You understand every dynamic, every challenge, every need we have.

Open our eyes to see where we need to grow. Soften our hearts to receive correction with humility. Strengthen our hands to do the work of building a marriage that

glorifies You.

Where we have wounds, bring healing. Where we have walls, bring them down. Where we have wandered, lead us back to Your design. We choose Your way over our way. We choose obedience over comfort. We choose each other over selfishness.

Unite us, Lord. Make us one in spirit, one in purpose, one in devotion to You and to each other. Let our marriage be a beacon of hope to every couple who knows us.

We believe Romans 8:28 - that You are working ALL things together for our good because we love You and are called according to Your purpose. Even the hard things. Even the painful things. You waste nothing.

In the mighty name of Jesus Christ, Amen.

MEMORY VERSE:

Nehemiah 8:10 - The joy of the LORD is your strength.

AFFIRMATIONS TO SPEAK OVER YOUR MARRIAGE THIS WEEK:

- Our marriage is blessed, protected, and empowered by God.
- We choose love over selfishness every single day.
- God is doing a new thing in our marriage, and we receive it with joy.
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ADDITIONAL REFLECTION:

As you close this chapter, take a moment to sit in silence together. Hold hands if you can. Breathe deeply. Remember why you chose each other. Remember the vows you made before God and witnesses.

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No matter what you are facing today - whether you are in a season of closeness or a season of distance, whether you are celebrating a victory or nursing a wound - God is present. He is not surprised by your circumstances. He is not overwhelmed by your problems. He is not disappointed in your progress.

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Love That Endures: A Covenant Renewed

1 Corinthians 13:4-7 - Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast.

In this chapter we explore love that endures: a covenant renewed through the lens of Scripture and its transformative application to Christian marriage.

Understanding love that endures: a covenant renewed is essential for every couple who desires to honor God in their union. The Bible does not leave us without guidance - it provides clear, practical, and powerful wisdom for this exact area.

Marriage was never meant to be navigated alone or by the wisdom of the world. God's Word is our ultimate authority, and His Spirit is our daily guide. When we align our marriage with His principles, we experience the abundant life Jesus promised (John 10:10).

THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATION:

Every principle in God's Word was given for our benefit. Deuteronomy 10:13 tells us that His commands are 'for thy good.' This means the boundaries and principles He sets for marriage are not restrictions - they are protections designed by a loving Father who knows exactly what we need.

When we resist God's design, we experience friction, frustration, and failure. When we embrace it, we experience peace, purpose, and profound connection with our spouse.

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Conclusion

Thank you for investing in your marriage by studying God's Word together.

A great marriage is not built in a day. It is built daily through small acts of love, forgiveness, prayer, and obedience to Scripture.

Keep this book nearby. Return to chapters that speak to your season. Share it with other couples who desire a God-honoring marriage.

Proverbs 3:5-6 - Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.

May God bless your marriage beyond what you can ask or imagine.
- Daniel Tesfamariam

About the Author

Daniel Tesfamariam is a Christian author and content creator passionate about helping couples build marriages that honor God. Through Bible Made Simple, he creates accessible, Scripture-based resources for believers.

YouTube: Bible Made Simple

Brand: KIDLYTICAL (Children's Resources)